

Moroccan Food



A Very Simple Guide to a Moroccan Feast

Here are simple steps for the key items on the table:

1. The Bread Basket (Essential)

- **Simple Rule:** Do not bake. Buy fresh pita bread, naan, or other flatbreads from a good bakery or market.
- **The Look:** Heat the bread until warm and soft, then stack them casually but abundantly in a basket lined with a cloth.

2. The Dipping Bowls (The Mezze)

This is about assembly, not complex cooking.

- **Step A (Hummus):** Use a pre-made premium hummus from the store. Spread it into a wide, shallow bowl.
- **Step B (The Drizzle):** Create a deep well in the center with a spoon. Fill it with a generous amount of good olive oil.
- **Step C (The Topping):** Top with either whole canned chickpeas (drained and rinsed), or a sprinkle of paprika or *za'atar* spice.

3. The Main: Lamb Tagine (The Copper Covered Dish)

A "tagine" is a slow-cooked stew. A "dum" method of slow-steaming works for simplification.

- **The Simplified Base:** Sauté one large onion and 2 cloves of garlic in a pot with oil until soft.
- **The Main Subject:** Add 1 kg (2 lbs) of lamb curry cut or beef. Brown the meat.
- **The Secret Spices:** Add a generous amount of *Ras el Hanout* spice blend (a North African mix available at most stores) or use a quality Tagine simmer sauce.
- **The Sweetness (Key):** Add a handful of dried dates or apricots and a small piece of a cinnamon stick. Add just enough water to almost cover the meat.
- **The Slow Cook:** Cover the pot tightly (use foil or a damp cloth *under* the lid to seal the steam). Simmer on the lowest possible heat for 1.5 to 2 hours until the meat is tender and the sauce is thick.

